

Interpersonal Conflict



DR. FAZEENA ALI

Outline



- Lecture learning outcomes
- Introduction: Definition of Conflict
- Types of Relationship-based Conflict
- Interpersonal Conflict (Dentist & Patient)
- Origin/Factors of Conflict
- Organizational Conflict
- Dysfunctional Outcomes of Conflict
- Conflict resolution

Lecture learning outcome



- Define conflicts and outline the sources of conflict
- Describe resolution of conflicts in healthcare

Definition of Conflict



- An interpersonal disagreement, or discord between two or more individuals,



due to difference in opinion, competition, negative perceptions, poorly defined role expectations or lack of communication.

- Conflict in healthcare: A disparity in an individual's perceptions, in relation to patient care.

McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. British Journal of Nursing. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.

Types of Relationship-based Conflict



1. Intrapersonal conflict: Internal conflict occurring within the individual.



2. Interpersonal conflict: Arises between two or more people with differing views or goals, which may lead to harassment and stress.



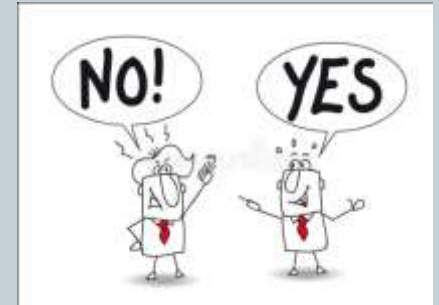
3. Intergroup conflict: Involves two or more teams who, for example, do not share the same organisational goals.



Why Interpersonal Conflict (Dentist & Patient) arise?



- Due to the participants disagreeing about what each person can reasonably expect the other to do.



- Rights and obligations of the dentist and the patient

RIGHTS CONTROL

GOVERN



INTERACTION

Eiser C, Ray C, Baum M, Schwartz S, Griffin T, Anderson BL, Janisse MP, Bochner S, Radley A. Contributions to Psychology and Medicine.

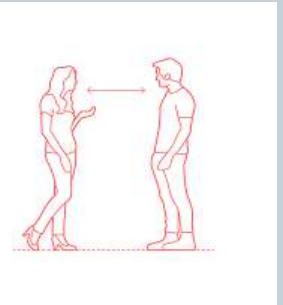
Dentist break two norms.....



1. Not causing pain; often broken in the dental relationship.



2. Intrusion of the dentist into the personal space of the patient;  stress.



Eiser C, Ray C, Baum M, Schwartz S, Griffin T, Anderson BL, Janisse MP, Bochner S, Radley A. Contributions to Psychology and Medicine.

Origin/Factors of Conflict



- Dentist's lack of interpersonal skills –
Communication breakdown: Absence of timely and specific feedback to one another, clear expectations around task completion, or information sharing
- Other factors: Environmental stress- Administrative limits caused by a tight schedule as well as the cost of treatment.



Kulich KR, Rydén O, Bengtsson H. A descriptive study of how dentists view their profession and the doctor-patient relationship. Acta Odontologica Scandinavica. 1998 Jan 1;56(4):206-9.

Factors of Conflict.....conti



- Policy in small dental businesses is often lacking
- Personal differences
- Role incompatibility
- Power differentials in positions, expertise, and roles.
- Dehumanisation



Kim S, Bochatay N, Relyea-Chew A, Buttrick E, Amdahl C, Kim L, Frans E, Mossanen M, Khandekar A, Fehr R, Lee YM. Individual, interpersonal, and organisational factors of healthcare conflict: a scoping review. Journal of interprofessional care. 2017 May 4;31(3):282-90.

Precipitating Factors of Conflict



- Autocracy, hostility, disrespect, inequities, hierarchy, low morale and absence of shared goals.



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Organizational Conflict



- Common interpersonal conflict is due to interpersonal frictions and tensions occurring between two or more team members.
- Have negative impact on team functioning, weakening stability, disrupting the way presently are and obstructing productivity.
- Impact on performance and reduced performance → impact on patient care.



Why ethical
relationship?
??

McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. British Journal of Nursing. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.

One-Five Predisposing Phases of Organizational Conflict



The first **latent** phase: When there is unease and conflict is imminent

The second **perceived** phase: Where there is believed conflict but it is minimized

The third **felt** phase: personalized conflict, where there is discomfort experienced.

The final two phases: When conflict is expressed, and the consequences, and how this affects the individuals and the team.

Dysfunctional Outcomes of Conflict



- Include stress, sickness, reduced job satisfaction, poor communications, distrust, suspicion, damaged inter-group relations, resistance and reduced function.



McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. British Journal of Nursing. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.

Conflict Resolution



- Addressing root causes (mending relationships, improving communication: transparent communication & listening, accepting change) facilitated via effective leadership and team management.

A red, rectangular stamp with a distressed, ink-like texture. The word "SOLVED" is written in a bold, serif font, slanted upwards from left to right. The stamp is set against a white background.

McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. British Journal of Nursing. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.

Conflict Resolution ...conti



- Best means for prevention: recognising the signs of and source of conflict.
- Styles of management: Collaborating, compromising, accommodating, and avoidance.



**What's Your
Management Style?**



McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. British Journal of Nursing. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.



- Avoiding seven Cs : commanding, comparing, condemning, challenging, condescending, contradicting and confusing.



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References



- McKibben L. Conflict management: importance and implications. *British Journal of Nursing*. 2017 Jan 26;26(2):100-3.
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- Eiser C, Ray C, Baum M, Schwartz S, Griffin T, Anderson BL, Janisse MP, Bochner S, Radley A. *Contributions to Psychology and Medicine*.



Thank You